

My Buddy

A private AI assistant that runs on a computer you control, so your team can ask questions about your own documents without handing them to a public chatbot.

THE PROBLEM IT SOLVES

Data walks out the door

People paste candidate details, salary bands and draft policies into free public chatbots because it is quicker than looking things up. Once that text leaves, you cannot recall it or show where it went.

The answers are hard to find

Handbooks, policy PDFs and onboarding notes sit across drives and inboxes. So staff ask a colleague instead, and the same questions land on the same desks every week.

Per-seat AI tools add up

Rolling out a commercial assistant means a licence for every employee, another vendor to review, and company material copied into someone else's platform.

WHAT IT IS

One application, running on a single computer or an internal server. You point it at your own material — handbook, leave policy, expense rules, onboarding pack — and people ask questions in plain English. **Every answer cites the document it came from**, so it can be checked rather than taken on trust. Documents and chat history stay in a folder on that machine, not in a vendor's database.

WHAT IT DOES

01 Answers from your documents

Upload policies and handbooks, then get answers with a citation to the exact source.

03 Deep research

For bigger questions it plans the work, investigates each part and writes a sourced summary.

05 Projects

Group documents by team or topic and restrict an assistant to only that material.

07 Usage dashboard

See what has been used and what it cost, with no per-seat licences to track.

02 Purpose-built assistants

Separate assistants for separate jobs, each with its own instructions and documents.

04 Live web search

Current information with links, when the answer depends on something recent.

06 Voice

Dictate a question instead of typing, and have the answer read back aloud.

08 Document search

Search everything indexed directly, to confirm what the assistant is drawing on.

WHERE IT HELPS AN HR TEAM

Policy questions

Staff self-serve on leave, expenses and benefits instead of emailing HR.

Onboarding

New joiners ask the handbook directly in their first weeks.

Drafting

First drafts of job descriptions, interview questions and internal notes.

Summarising

Long provider documents cut down to the changes that matter.

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU CIRCULATE IT

Where the data sits

Uploaded documents and chat history are stored only on the machine running the app. To write an answer, the question and the relevant excerpts are sent to Anthropic's Claude service, which supplies the language model; the material is not used to train it.

What it is not

It is built for one machine, so there are no company logins, user permissions or audit trail. Treat it as a personal or small-team tool. Anything needing per-employee access control or a formal record of who asked what would need a different setup.

What it takes to run

A computer or internal server, an Anthropic account for the model, and about ten minutes to set up. Cost follows usage rather than headcount, so a small pilot stays inexpensive.